

Ideation Phase Empathize & Discover

Date	30 September 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Script-Controlled ACL – Restrict Record Access Based on Field Value
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas:

An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviours and attitudes.

It is a useful tool to help teams better understand their users.

Creating an effective solution requires understanding the true problem and the person who is experiencing it. The exercise of creating the map helps participants consider things from the user's perspective along with his or her goals and challenges.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/empathy-map-canvas>

Empathy Map: ServiceNow Administrator / Data Owner

User: a ServiceNow administrator who owns a table of sensitive records and must control who can read, create, edit and delete each record.

THINK & FEEL

- Worried that confidential records could be opened by anyone who simply holds a common role.
- Wants fine-grained control, not an all-or-nothing role check.
- Feels pressure to stay audit-ready and compliant.
- Unsure whether a scripted rule might lock out the wrong people.

HEAR

- Security team: "Only the right people should see restricted records."
- Managers: "My team must still reach the records that belong to them."
- Peers: role-only ACLs are too broad for record-level security.

SEE

- Users viewing records in lists and reports that they should not.
- Roles assigned widely, and ACLs with no condition or script.
- Documentation showing ACL scripts that return answer = true/false.

SAY & DO

- Creates test users, roles and a custom table to work with.
- Writes ACLs for Read, Create, Write and Delete, one milestone at a time.
- Asks: "Can access depend on the value of a field in the record?"
- Impersonates each user to check what they can and cannot see, then adjusts the script.

PAIN

- Role-based ACLs cannot look at the values inside a record.
- A script error can either lock everyone out or leave data exposed.
- Testing all four operations for each role is slow and repetitive.

GAIN

- Records are visible only when the field value and the user's role both match.
- Consistent behaviour across Read, Create, Write and Delete.
- A tested, reusable pattern that is ready for audit.